

Mind the Mistake — Practice

Section A is interactive. Sections B and C are written practice — check them against the separate answer key.

Objective (1 mark each)**Q1 • MCQ****[1]**

The correct expansion of $(5m + 6n)^2$ is:

- (a) $25m^2 + 36n^2$ (b) $25m^2 + 60mn + 36n^2$ (c) $25m^2 - 60mn + 36n^2$ (d) $11mn$

Q2 • MCQ**[1]**

$-3p(-5p + 2q)$ equals:

- (a) $15p^2 - 6pq$ (b) $-3p + 5p - 2q$ (c) $-15p^2 - 6pq$ (d) $15p^2 + 6pq$

Q3 • FILL IN THE BLANK**[1]**

$2(x - 1) + 3(x + 4)$ simplifies to $5x + \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$.

Q4 • MCQ**[1]**

Which simplification is correct?

- (a) $5w^2 + 6w = 11w^2$ (b) $5w^2 + 6w = 11w$ (c) $5w^2 + 6w$ cannot be simplified further
(d) $5w^2 + 6w = 30w^3$

Q5 • TRUE / FALSE**[1]**

$(5m + 6n)^2 = 25m^2 + 36n^2$.

True False

Q6 · ASSERTION-REASON**[1]**

Assertion (A): Writing $(a + b)^2 = a^2 + b^2$ is incorrect.

Reason (R): The middle term $2ab$ has been left out.

- (a) Both true, R explains A (b) Both true, R does not explain A (c) A true, R false
(d) A false, R true

Short answer (2 marks each)

Q7**[2]**

Find and correct the mistake: $-3p(-5p + 2q) = -3p + 5p - 2q$.

Q8**[2]**

Find and correct the mistake: $2(x - 1) + 3(x + 4) = 5x + 3$.

Q9**[2]**

A student wrote $2a^3 + 3a^3 + 6a^2b + 6ab^2 = 5a^3 + 12a^2b^2$. Correct it.

Long answer (3 marks each)

Q10**[3]**

Spot and correct the error, explaining what went wrong: $(5m + 6n)^2 = 25m^2 + 36n^2$.

Q11

[3]

Expand $(x + 2)(x + 5)$ correctly, showing all four products before simplifying.

Q12

[3]

A student simplified $y + 2(y + 2)$ as $(y + 2)^2 = y^2 + 4y + 4$. Explain why this is wrong and give the correct simplest form.

Total: 21 marks · Check your work against the [answer key](#).